

Teaching Statement

I approach a course as a design problem and revise it against evidence of what students do. I have taught as instructor of record since 2022, first at Texas A&M University. There I taught asynchronous online sections with more than four hundred students and received the Dean's Award for Outstanding Teaching by a Doctoral Student. Since 2025 I have been an assistant professor at Truman State University, where I teach Principles of Finance, Personal Finance, and Financial Modeling and Valuation.

Course Design and Curricular Contribution

Treating a course as a design problem sometimes means designing the course itself. When I arrived at Truman State, nothing in the curriculum required students to apply what they had learned to an actual company. I was assigned Seminar in Finance, a general course built on essays and visiting speakers, and I proposed replacing it with a course in financial modeling and valuation. The revision was approved through the curriculum process, and the catalog title changes in the 2026–27 year. I taught the course in its revised form for the first time in Spring 2026.

Students choose a public company and carry it through to an equity valuation. They analyze the industry and the firm's competitors, examine its capital structure, and estimate the cost of equity and the cost of debt before arriving at a value. The inputs come from primary filings, not from a prepared dataset. Every assumption is one the student makes and states.

Assessment After Generative AI

Teaching online presents two challenges. The first is that a student working alone has no one to notice when they have not understood something, so the course has to check. The second is that conventional assessment has been hard to rely on since generative models became widely available, and an online course makes it harder still.

Personal Finance became an asynchronous course in Fall 2026. I designed it around recorded video. I rebuilt the slides around figures and diagrams and cut them into segments short enough to carry a fifteen to twenty minute video, each closing on a single idea. Every video ends with questions on what it covered, and every week ends with an open-book quiz over that week's videos. The checks help students catch what they have missed before the next topic builds on it.

To limit what a generative AI model can supply, I rewrote the assignments so that each student works with a different set of figures. The figures come from digits in the student's own identification number, and the task asks the student to apply the material to their own finances. A submission produced from the prompt alone does not satisfy the task, and answers cannot pass between students.

Courses

I have taught Principles of Finance, Personal Finance, Financial Modeling and Valuation, and an introductory survey course in finance. One of them I have taught in person, in hybrid form, and asynchronously online.

I am prepared to teach corporate finance, investment analysis, international finance, and corporate valuation without additional preparation. I served as teaching assistant for investment analysis, international finance, and valuation at Texas A&M University, and for International Finance I built the course with the instructor from the ground up.

I would develop two courses. One is mergers and acquisitions. The other is textual analysis and machine learning in finance, which would give students the means to construct their own text-based measures. I would welcome doctoral students working in this area.